

YOUR FULL REPORT

Do you push people away?

Closeness feels unsafe

Score band: 36–45 points · Relationships

What this report covers

A gentle plan for rebuilding safety when closeness regularly feels dangerous, costly, or overwhelming.

Inside:

1. Why rejecting first can feel protective
2. A safe-person practice plan
3. How trauma-informed support may help

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Your result

Closeness feels unsafe (36–45 points)

You may regularly protect yourself by rejecting, testing, or vanishing first. This can be lonely, and it is worth exploring with a trauma-informed professional if you can.

Try this next

Choose one safe person and practice asking for a defined amount of space with a clear return time.

Your practical guide

A gentle plan for rebuilding safety when closeness regularly feels dangerous, costly, or overwhelming.

1 Why rejecting first can feel protective

Rejecting first can feel like the only safe move when closeness has historically meant pain — being left, controlled, criticized, or overwhelmed. Your system learned a simple equation: if I end it, choose it, or stay numb, nobody can blindsides me. That strategy once protected you, and it deserves respect rather than shame. But notice its current cost: the loneliness that follows the relief, the relationships that never got past the audition, the way safety starts to feel identical to isolation. You are not broken for having this pattern; you adapted to real experiences. The question now is whether the adaptation still serves the life you want.

2 A safe-person practice plan

Choose one safe person — a steady friend, a sibling, a counselor — and practice closeness in structured, time-limited doses. Agree on the frame in advance: "Can we talk for twenty minutes about something real? I might get quiet, and that does not mean I want to stop." During the conversation, practice two skills: staying when discomfort rises instead of mentally leaving, and naming the urge out loud ("I want to shut down right now") without obeying it. End by noting one thing that went better than feared. This is exposure therapy you run yourself: small, repeated proof that vulnerability does not always end in harm. If even this feels impossible, that is information for the next section, not a verdict on you.

3 How trauma-informed support may help

When closeness consistently feels dangerous, costly, or overwhelming, a trauma-informed therapist can help in ways self-help cannot — by working with your nervous system, not just your thoughts. Look for someone who mentions attachment, complex trauma, or somatic approaches, and who lets you set the pace; a good first question is "how do you work with clients who shut down or pull away?" You deserve support that does not pathologize your protection. If therapy is out of reach right now, structured books and support groups focused on attachment can be a bridge. The goal was never to force yourself to feel safe — it is to build, slowly, a life where safety becomes plausible.